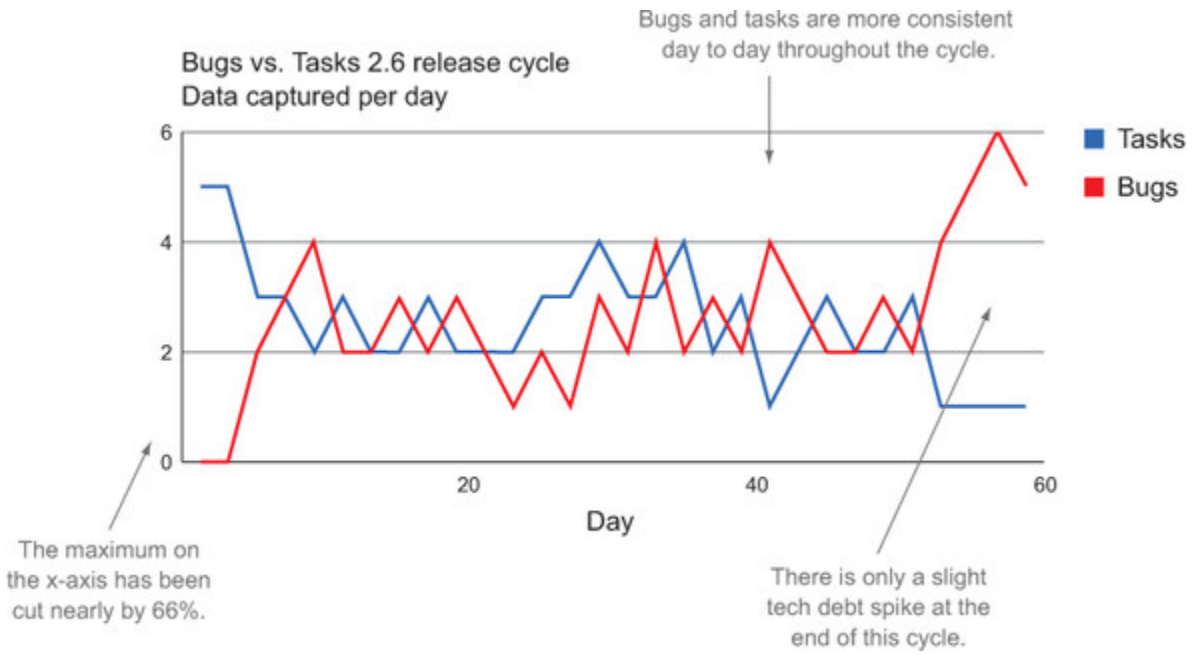
At a glance it seemed horrible that there was a one-month hardening period. Some of the developers on the project wanted to move to a more continuous delivery type model where they didn't build up any tech debt as they went along to potentially shave time off the release cycle.

The team was able to use the data from their release cycle to convince the stakeholders to change how the team was delivering code with the promise of more frequent releases. After a release they started seeing the benefits. They finished tasks at a slower pace, but they were able to work out the kinks and get the release out the door on time. The updated release cycle is shown in figure 9.14.

Figure 9.14. The updated velocity and volume for the team after they changed their development practices



At first everyone was really excited that they were able to deliver faster. Counterintuitively, when the release went out they noticed their star ratings on the app store started to decline. They dug into the results and noticed consumers nitpicking the new features they had released. After meeting and discussing how this could have happened, they pointed back to the shortened development cycle, which included a much-abridged beta. It turned out that in their previous way of developing software they were able to get a buggy version into their beta users' hands very quickly. This led to